Criminal Investigation Department (CID)/ Counter Terrorism Department (CTD)

Provincial police intelligence agencies like Special Branch were neither trained nor willing to counter this sort of terrorism. The Criminal Investigation Department, Punjab, had played a substantial role in quelling the sectarian terrorism in the 1990s. In order to dedicate it for counter-terrorism, it was renamed as Counter Terrorism Department (CTD) on 21 July 2010, but it could not repeat the performance. Counter Terrorism Department (CTD) was created by the vision and desire of the Chief Minister of Punjab to have a dedicated counter-terrorism department. It had previous experience, expertise, personnel and paraphernalia as it had been dealing with sectarian terrorism since 1995. Unfortunately, its renaming and revamping in 2010 had little effect on its performance. The non-performance of CTD was mainly due to its leadership's timidity to take on the terrorists head on and the lack of a clear vision. Some reasons are enumerated as follows:

i. CTD restricted its role to interrogate only arrested terrorists by other departments. It mostly borrowed arrested and jailed terrorists to interrogate. Pro-active actions were very few.
ii. As a result of the above reason, the emphasis had been on low-priority activities such as reporting of loudspeaker violation at mosques. The police and special branch were already doing this job more effectively.
iii. More emphasis was on event reporting instead of intelligence reporting. Approximately 98 per cent of reports were based on the coverage of events.
iv. Majority of officers and staff of CTD had no training, temperament and taste for intelligence, whereas counter-terrorism is 85 per cent intelligence and 15 per cent law enforcement.
v. Fear of terrorists' backlash prevented the officers from indulging in taking direct action and carrying out real counter-terrorism.

Conceptually, CTD emerged as the most suitable organisation to counter terrorism as it had the intelligence set-up and the strike force as well. Moreover, it had the powers to register cases against the culprits and interrogate them. It was headed by an Additional Inspector General of